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IITM Successfully Hosts Techno Sapiens 2K26, Annual Tech Fest Marked by Enthusiastic Participation and Innovation

Ananya Manchanda

The Institute of Information Technology & Management, affiliated to Guru Gobind Singh Indraprastha University, successfully organized its much-anticipated Annual Tech Event, Techno Sapiens 2K26, on 2nd and 3rd February 2026. Conducted by AIEC in collaboration with the Department of Computer Science, the two-day technical fest witnessed remarkable participation from 656 students representing various prestigious institutions, including colleges from Bareilly, Gwalior, the University of Delhi, Amity University, and several other renowned universities. The event emerged as a vibrant inter-institutional con-

vergence of young innovators, coders, designers, and gaming enthusiasts. The fest commenced with an inaugural ceremony at 9:30 A.M. in the institute auditorium, where faculty members, organizers, and participants gathered to mark the formal beginning of the event. The inauguration highlighted the importance of innovation, technical excellence, teamwork, and experiential learning beyond traditional classroom teaching. Spread across multiple venues on campus, the fest featured a total of 16 events designed to test technical expertise, analytical thinking, creativity, and strategic skills. Day 1 included competitions such as Techno Bid, Dash-



board Masters, Design Dual (Poster Presentation), Ideathon, SQL Warriors, Web Forge (Web Development), Blind Code, Hunt Safari, and Arena Ascension (LAN Gaming – BGMI and VALORANT). These events provided hands-on exposure in coding, database management, data visualization, web development, logical reasoning, and team coordination. The gaming segment attracted enthusiastic

participation, promoting strategic planning and collaborative gameplay. Day 2 began with Techno Exhibit, where students showcased innovative projects, technical models, and prototypes. Other key events included Mind Spark Quiz, Tech Vivad (Technical Debate), Bug Bounty, Reel Exe Showcasing, and the final rounds of Arena Ascension. These competitions enhanced the participants' debugging

skills, communication abilities, creativity, and awareness of contemporary technological issues. Winners of each event were awarded trophies and cash prizes based on structured evaluation criteria. The systematic planning and coordinated efforts of faculty coordinators and student volunteers ensured the smooth execution of all activities. Techno Sapiens 2K26 concluded with a closing ceremony, celebrating the spirit of innovation and healthy competition. The fest significantly enhanced students' technical competence, leadership qualities and confidence, reaffirming IITM's commitment to fostering skill development, creativity, and academic excellence in the field of technology.

UNICORN ZERO Startup Competition Concludes at COMMPARV 3.0

IITM Bureau

The Department of Commerce at the Institute of Information Technology and Management (IITM) successfully organized an exciting startup competition titled "Unicorn Zero: From Zero to Scale" as part of COMMPARV 3.0 2K26 on February 17 2026. The two-day event brought together enthusiastic students and budding entrepreneurs who competed to present innovative and scalable startup ideas in a challenging and competitive environment. The competition consisted of three rigorous qualifying rounds, designed to test participants' entrepreneurial skills, strategic thinking, and ability to make real-time de-



cisions. From pitching distinguished panel of high-impact startup judges comprising Ms. Kajal Kumari, Associate Lead Programme Development at Tata STRIVE; Mr. Yogesh Kumar, Co-Founder of Chargespot, Tech Entrepreneur and Startup India Seed Fund Grant Award-ee; and Dr. Saarthak Bakshi, Co-Founder of Neos Angels Network and Founder & CEO of RISAA IVF. The judges appreciated the participants' creativity, problem-solving abilities, and innovative approaches to entrepreneurship. The competition was evaluated by a dis-

IITM Successfully Organizes CommParv 3.0 - 2K26, A Grand Inter-College Commerce Fest Showcasing Innovation, Strategy, and Leadership

IITM Bureau

The Institute of Information Technology & Management, affiliated with Guru Gobind Singh Indraprastha University, successfully organized CommParv 3.0 – 2K26, the third edition of its Annual Inter-College Commerce Fest, on 17th and 18th February 2026. The two-day mega event, comprising 16 working hours of competitions and activities, witnessed an impressive participation of 432 students from colleges affiliated with GGSIPU, the University of Delhi, and other reputed institutions. The fest served as a dynamic academic platform that brought together budding commerce professionals to compete, collaborate, and innovate. Organized by The Commerce Club of IITM, CommParv 3.0 aimed to bridge the gap between classroom learning and real-world business applications. The primary objective was to enhance students' practical knowledge in commerce, finance, marketing, entrepreneurship, and

emerging technologies while promoting inter-college collaboration. The fest also sought to encourage innovation, analytical thinking, leadership, and strategic decision-making through experiential learning formats. The event featured an extensive lineup of competitions categorized under Business & Strategy, Finance & Trading, Creative & Marketing, and Technology & Emerging Commerce. Business events such as The Vault: Business Escape Room, BizAct: Corporate Crossroads, Unicon Zero (Startup Challenge), Comm Circuit (Commerce Quiz), and NextGen Minds tested participants' problem-solving and business ideation skills. Finance enthusiasts engaged in Fin-Clue Frenzy, The Trading Room (Live Stock Market Simulation), and Alpha Traders League, which provided hands-on exposure to trading strategies and financial decision-making. Creative minds showcased their talent in Reel to Retail,



Collageconomics: Art Meets Commerce, and Capture the Moment, blending marketing concepts with artistic expression. The event AI X Commerce highlighted the growing relevance of Artificial Intelligence in modern business practices, reflecting the fest's focus on contemporary industry trends. CommParv 3.0 commenced with a traditional lamp-lighting ceremony graced by eminent dignitaries including Ms. Seema Sharma (Member, Governing Body IITM), Prof. (Dr.) Rachita Rana (Director IITM), Prof. (Dr.) Ganesha Wadhvani (Deputy Director IITM), Dr. Vikas Bharara, and Dr. Raghav Jain. Their presence underscored the academic signifi-

cance and grandeur of the occasion. All competitions were efficiently managed by faculty event in-charges with the support of dedicated student coordinators. Winners and runners-up were awarded cash prizes and certificates of excellence, while participation certificates were distributed to all competitors. Student coordinators were also honored with certificates of appreciation for their commendable efforts. CommParv 3.0 - 2K26 successfully blended academics, creativity, competition, and innovation. The fest not only enhanced students' analytical abilities, but also strengthened inter-college networking and collaboration.

Parindey - The Dramatics Society of IITM Secures First Position at Women's Day Nukkad Natak Competition

IITM Bureau

Ananya Manchanda The Institute of Information Technology & Management proudly celebrates a remarkable cultural achievement as Parindey - The Dramatics Society of IITM secured First Position at the Nukkad Natak Competition organized on 20th February 2026 at Zakir Husain Delhi College (Evening). The event was conducted by the Women Development Cell of the host college on the occasion of Women's Day, creating a meaningful platform for artistic expression, awareness, and dialogue on issues related to women's rights and empowerment. Representing IITM with dedication, enthusiasm, and a strong sense of purpose, the team presented a powerful and socially relevant street play focusing on themes such as women's dignity, equality, strength, and empowerment. Through impactful dialogues, expressive body language, synchronized movements, and emotionally en-

gaging storytelling, the performers effectively highlighted contemporary challenges faced by women in society. Their narrative emphasized the importance of respect, equal opportunities, and collective responsibility in bringing about social change. The Nukkad Natak format, known for its dynamic engagement with live audiences and its ability to convey strong social messages in a direct and relatable manner, was utilized with great skill and confidence by the team. The performance not only showcased the artistic talent and stage presence of the students but also reflected their sensitivity towards gender issues and social realities. The team's coordination, clarity of message, and energetic presentation created a lasting impact on both the judges and the audience. The competition saw participation from several reputed institutions, making the achievement even more commendable.



Securing the first position in such a competitive environment stands as a testament to the team's consistent rehearsals, creativity, and collective teamwork. This accomplishment adds another proud milestone to IITM's legacy of excellence in cultural and co-curricular activities. The institute extends heartfelt congratulations to the entire Parindey team for their outstanding performance and for upholding the spirit of creativity and social responsibility. The achievement once again reinforces IITM's commitment to holistic student development, encouraging learners to excel academically while also contributing meaningfully to society through art and expression.

Canadian PM Mark Carney Participates In Innovation Showcase; Meets University Researchers In Mumbai

Samridhi

Canadian PM Mark Carney on 28 february participated in innovation showcase and met university researchers in Mumbai. The meetings came part of Carney's first official visit to India, taking place from February 27 to March 2 at the invitation of Narendra Modi. Coinciding with his visit, India and Canada also launched a Talent and Innovation Strategy, with the Minister of State for Education Jayant Chaudhary stating that India stands ready to work with Canada to build globally competitive talent, deepen research collaboration and strengthen skills mobility. In his address,

Jayant Chaudhary said, "India Canada Talent and Innovation Strategy is timely, and it will be consequential. Its four pillars, embedding Canadian capability in Indian priority sectors, translating knowledge and talent into economic outcomes, deepening and rebalancing two-way mobility, and demonstrating credibility through speed and delivery, resonate strongly with our national priorities." He further added that, "We see this partnership not just as an education initiative, but it's a shared investment in our shared future." PM Carney arrived in Mumbai on February 27 on his first official visit to India. He will



arrive in New Delhi on March 1 and on March 2 hold delegation-level talks at Hyderabad House with Prime Minister Narendra Modi. After his Mumbai visit, Carney will arrive in Delhi on March 1. On March 2, Carney and PM Modi will hold delegation-level talks at Hyderabad House. As part of the agenda, both the leaders will review

the progress achieved to date across diverse areas of the India-Canada Strategic Partnership, building on their earlier meetings in Kananaskis (June 2025) and Johannesburg (November 2025). Moreover, they will also take stock of ongoing cooperation in key pillars, including trade and investment; energy; critical minerals; agriculture;

education, research, and innovation; and people-to-people ties. The two leaders will also exchange views on regional and global developments. Later in the day, they also attend the India-Canada CEOs Forum. The visit is Carney's first official trip to India at the invitation of Narendra Modi, aimed at strengthening bilateral ties.

CBI Moves Delhi HC Against Discharge of Arvind Kejriwal and Manish Sisodia in Excise Policy Case

IITM Bureau

The Central Bureau of Investigation will approach the Delhi High Court, challenging the Rouse Avenue Court judgment discharging Aam Aadmi Party leaders Arvind Kejriwal and Manish Sisodia in the Delhi Excise policy case, sources in the probe agency said on Friday. The move comes after the Rouse Avenue court observed that the alleged central conspiratorial role of the AAP leaders could not be substantiated. The court noted that the allegations “failed judicial scrutiny” and found “no criminal intent” on the part of Manish Sisodia. It further stated that the conspiracy theory “cannot



survive against one constitutional authority.” The CBI filed its first chargesheet in 2022, followed by multiple supplementary chargesheets. The agency has alleged that Rs 100 crore was paid by a “south lobby” to influence the now-scrapped excise policy in its favour. In total, 23 accused have been chargesheeted, including Arvind Kejriwal, Manish Sisodia, and P

Sarath Chandra Reddy. During arguments, the CBI maintained that the offence of criminal conspiracy must be viewed in its entirety and that the sufficiency of evidence should be tested during trial. Represented by Additional Solicitor General D P Singh and advocate Manu Mishra, the agency argued that there is adequate material to frame charges against all the accused.

Right to passport is part of personal liberty guaranteed under Article 21: Delhi HC

IITM Bureau

Passengers can now cancel or change air tickets without paying an additional charge within 48 hours of booking, subject to certain conditions, with the aviation watchdog DGCA revising the ticket refund norms for airlines. Coming out with the amended norms that are more passenger-friendly, DGCA also said that airlines should not levy any additional charge for correction in the name of the same person when the error is pointed out by the passenger within 24 hours of making the booking, when the ticket is booked directly through the air-



line's website. "In case of purchase of ticket through travel agent/portal, onus of refund shall lie with the airlines as agents are their appointed representatives. The airlines shall ensure that the refund process is completed within 14 working days," the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) said. Besides, there are changes with respect to norms for ticket cancellations due to a medical emergency faced by the passenger. The amendments to the Civil Aviation Requirements (CAR) for 'Refund of Airline Tickets to Passengers of Public Transport Undertakings' come against the backdrop of the rising passenger complaints about not receiving refunds on time. The ticket refund issue also got highlighted during the IndiGo flight dis-

ruptions in December 2025, and at that time, the civil aviation ministry had directed the airline to complete the refunds within a specified timeline. The revised CAR was issued on February 24. The revised rules are expected to improve transparency and strengthen passenger rights in the aviation sector. By ensuring quicker refunds and allowing corrections without extra charges, the DGCA aims to make air travel more convenient and fair for passengers. These changes will also encourage airlines to follow clearer refund procedures and address customer complaints more effectively.

IITM Bureau

The Supreme Court on February 16 2026 refused to entertain pleas seeking action against Assam chief minister Himanta Biswa Sarma over a viral video allegedly showing him taking aim and firing a rifle at members of a particular community. A top court bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and Vipul M Pancholi asked the petitioners to move the Gauhati High Court with their pleas, news agency PTI reported. The apex court asked why the petitioners hadn't moved the Gauhati HC, warning them not to undermine its authority. "Why haven't you gone to the

SC refuses to entertain pleas against Assam CM Himanta Sarma over viral 'shooting' video row

Gauhati High Court? Don't undermine its authority... Will ask parties to use restraint and remain within the boundaries of constitutional morality, but this is becoming a trend just before the polls," the top court said. "This is a disturbing trend that every matter ends up here," the Supreme Court stated, adding that the high courts have already been deprived of environmental and commercial litigations. Senior advocate Abhishek Singhvi, for the petitioners, submitted before the top court that Sarma is a "habitual and repeat offender", urging the court to entertain the matter. However, the SC bench refused to do so and directed the

petitioners to approach the high court. Further, it also asked the chief justice of the Gauhati HC to expedite the hearing in the matter. On February 10, the Supreme Court agreed to consider a plea moved by Left leaders, seeking action against the Assam chief minister.

In reference to the upcoming assembly elections in the state, the apex court said the problem is that a part of the polls are fought before the actual event. It also noted the submissions of lawyer Nizam Pasha, appearing for a few CPI and CPI(M) leaders, against Sarma, stating that it would consider listing the plea. The official X handle of

the BJP's Assam unit had shared a video of Sarma on February 7 with the caption "point blank shot". The video purportedly showed Sarma taking aim with a rifle and firing a shot at a photo of two individuals, both wearing a skull cap, HT reported earlier.

The video also included a photo of the CM with a text saying, “Identity, land and roots come first; Why did you go to Pakistan; No forgiveness for Bangladeshis.” The post drew massive fire from Opposition parties. The Congress slammed the video and said it appeared to glorify the targeted, which the party described as a “point-blank murder of minorities”.

Indian Air Force conducts Exercise Vayushakti-26 at Pokhran range

IITM Bureau

The Indian Air Force on February 27 2026, conducted Exercise Vayushakti-26 at the Pokhran Field Firing Range in Rajasthan's Jaisalmer district, showcasing its combat readiness and capability to carry out integrated air operations across the full spectrum of warfare. Droupadi Murmu attended the firepower demonstration as the Chief Guest. She was accompanied by Haribhau Kisanrao Bagde, Rajnath Singh, Kinjarapu Ram Mohan Naidu, Gajendra Singh Shekhawat, Raj Kumar Goyal, T. V. Somanathan and Anil Chauhan, along with



senior military officers, defence attaches, veterans, government officials, media representatives and school children. Earlier in the day, the President undertook a sortie in the indigenously developed Light Combat Helicopter Prachand, underlining India's push for self-reliance in defence production. For the first time, the exercise followed a defined operational

storyline, turning the event into a simulated live combat theatre. The drill integrated offensive air strikes, air defence operations, special forces missions and humanitarian assistance tasks, highlighting the Air Force's role as a multi-domain force and first responder during crises. The exercise began with the National Song and National Anthem, followed by a ceremonial flypast by Chetak

helicopters carrying the National Flag, Air Force Ensign and Operation Sindoor flag. A Rafale fighter then performed a sonic boom, marking the start of high-intensity combat demonstrations. More than 130 aircraft took part in the day-and-night exercise. The fleet included Rafale, Su-30 MKI, Mirage-2000, MiG-29, Jaguar and Hawk fighter jets, along with Mi-17 helicopters and transport aircraft such as C-130J, C-295 and C-17. The indigenous Advanced Light Helicopter Dhruv and Light Combat Helicopter Prachand also participated.

Wrong order can't be sole ground for disciplinary action against judicial officer: Supreme Court

IITM Bureau

Eight Members of Parliament belonging to the Congress party were suspended from the Lok Sabha on Tuesday (February 3 2026) for the remainder of the ongoing Budget Session for allegedly disrupting the proceedings of the House and throwing papers towards the Chair. The action was taken following repeated disturbances that prevented the House from conducting its scheduled business. The suspended MPs include Amrinder Singh Raja Warring, Manickam Tagore, Gurjeet Singh

Aujla, Hibi Eden, C. Kiran Kumar Reddy, Prashant Yadaorao Padole, S. Venkatesh, and Dean Kuriakose. According to parliamentary officials, the members were involved in protests inside the House that led to continuous disruptions during the session. The announcement regarding the suspension was made by Dilip Saikia, who was presiding over the House at the time. Addressing the members, Saikia stated that while the opposition has every right to raise issues and express dissent in Parliament, the manner in which the pro-

tests were carried out was not in accordance with parliamentary traditions. He emphasised that Parliament is a platform meant for constructive debate and discussion. "The House belongs to everyone and members have the right to voice their concerns. However, completely disrupting proceedings and bringing the House to a standstill in the name of protest is not acceptable," he said while announcing the decision. The motion to suspend the eight MPs was passed amid loud protests and sloganeering from the opposition

benches. Opposition members strongly objected to the decision, arguing that they were exercising their democratic right to raise important issues. Following the passage of the motion and the continuing uproar in the House, the Lok Sabha proceedings were adjourned for the day. The incident highlights the growing tensions between the ruling government and the opposition during the ongoing Budget Session of Parliament. The incident reflects rising tensions between the government and the opposition.

The CIA makes a new push to recruit Chinese military officers as informants

Manya Bharti

In a significant escalation of its intelligence operations against Beijing, the Central Intelligence Agency launched a new recruitment campaign on Thursday, February 12, 2026, specifically targeting disillusioned members of the Chinese military.

This latest effort follows the recent and high-profile purge of General Zhang Youxia, the Vice Chairman of the Central Military Commission and a top-tier leader within the People's Liberation Army. By releasing a polished, Mandarin-language video across various digital platforms, U.S. intelligence aims to capitalize on the inter-



national friction and paranoia currently rippling through the Chinese defense establishment. The video features a fictional mid-level officer who expresses deep resentment toward the ruling Communist Party, suggesting that any display of genuine leadership within the PLA is now met with suspicion and “ruthless elimination.” This narrative appears strategically designed to reso-

nate with officers who feel vulnerable under President Xi Jinping's expansive and ongoing anti-corruption crackdown. CIA Director John Ratcliffe emphasized that these public outreach efforts provide Chinese officials with a rare opportunity to pursue a “brighter future” by cooperating with Washington.

This move builds upon a similar campaign initiated last May, which

utilized fictional party figures to provide technical instructions on how to bypass the “Great Firewall” and establish secure, anonymous contact with American intelligence. The timing of the video is particularly pointed, appearing just weeks after the Ministry of Defense confirmed that Zhang Youxia is under investigation. For the CIA, this represents a major push to rebuild

its human intelligence networks, which suffered catastrophic losses between 2010 and 2012. Agency officials remain confident that their digital strategy is successfully penetrating China's domestic internet restrictions, claiming past videos have already garnered millions of views and successfully inspired new informants.

As Beijing continues to publicize its own efforts to dismantle what it describes as U.S. spy rings, this latest maneuver by the CIA signals a more aggressive and public phase in the clandestine struggle between the two global powers for control over critical military and political secrets.

U.S. Judge Allows Trump's \$10 Billion Lawsuit against BBC to Move Forward

Suhani Ranjan

A U.S. federal judge has rejected a request by the BBC to pause legal proceedings in a \$10 billion defamation lawsuit filed by former U.S. President Donald Trump. The decision, issued on February 11, 2026, allows the case to move forward, with a trial now scheduled for February 2027 in Miami. The lawsuit centers on the BBC's editing of a speech delivered by Trump on January 6, 2021, shortly before the riot at the U.S. Capitol in Washington. Trump alleges that the broadcaster unfairly edited portions of his remarks in a way that damaged his reputation. According to court filings, the

complaint claims the BBC combined separate excerpts of the speech, creating the impression that Trump directly encouraged supporters to storm the Capitol building. The lawsuit further argues that a key portion of the speech in which Trump urged his supporters to protest “peacefully” was removed from the edited version. Trump's legal team contends that this omission significantly altered the meaning and context of his remarks, contributing to what they describe as reputational harm on a global scale. The BBC has acknowledged that the edit was misleading and has issued an apology. However, the

organization strongly disputes the \$10 billion damages claim. It has asked the court to dismiss the case, arguing that the documentary containing the edited footage was not broadcast in Florida, where the lawsuit was filed. The BBC also maintains that Trump cannot demonstrate serious harm, pointing out that he was re-elected in 2024. By declining to delay the discovery phase, the judge has cleared the way for both sides to begin exchanging evidence and documents. The case is expected to attract significant international attention, raising questions about media responsibility

Kremlin says neither China nor Russia have carried out secret nuclear tests

Anushka Pandey

The Kremlin said on Feb 18 that neither China nor Russia have carried out secret nuclear tests, noting Beijing had denied U.S. accusations that it had done so. The United States this month accused China of conducting a secret nuclear test in 2020 as it called for a new, broader arms control treaty that would bring in China as well as Russia. “We've heard many references to certain tests. Both the Russian Federation and China have been mentioned in this regard. Neither the Russian Federation nor China has conducted any

nuclear tests,” Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov told reporters. “We also know that these allegations were categorically denied by a representative of the People's Republic of China, so that's the situation,” added Peskov. U.S. President Donald Trump is pressing China to join the U.S. and Russia to negotiate a replacement pact to New START, the last U.S.-Russian nuclear arms control agreement which expired on February 5. The treaty's expiration has fuelled concerns among some experts that the world is on the verge of an accelerated nuclear arms race,

though other arms control experts say such fears are exaggerated. Amid these developments, several international security experts have urged major powers to resume dialogue and strengthen global arms control frameworks. They warn that rising mistrust between nuclear-armed countries could increase geopolitical tensions and reduce transparency in nuclear activities. Analysts believe that renewed negotiations and confidence-building measures are essential to maintain strategic stability and prevent the risk of a new global nuclear arms race.

Ukraine war talks in Geneva end without agreement on territory

Anjali Yadav

The United States has been pushing for an end to the nearly four-year war, which has killed tens of thousands and destroyed much of eastern and southern Ukraine, but Moscow and Kyiv remain at odds over who gets what land in a post-war settlement. Russia is pushing for full control of Ukraine's eastern Donetsk region as part of any deal, and has threatened to take it by force if Kyiv does not cave at the negotiating table. But Ukraine has rejected this demand, which is politically and militarily fraught, and signalled it will not sign



a deal without security guarantees that deter Russia from invading again. “We can see that some groundwork has been done, but for now the positions differ, because the negotiations were not easy,” Zelensky said in a message to journalists, including from AFP, after the talks had finished. The two sides agreed on “almost all issues” related to a ceasefire

monitoring mechanism which will involve the United States, Zelensky said. But sensitive issues related to the fate of occupied territory in Ukraine's east and the future status of the Russian-occupied Zaporizhzhia Nuclear Power Plant remained unresolved, Zelensky added. The head of Russia's delegation said the talks were “difficult, but busi-

ness-like” and that further negotiations were planned for the future. Russia launched its full-scale invasion of Ukraine in February 2022. The ensuing conflict has resulted in a tidal wave of destruction that has left entire cities in ruins, tens of thousands of soldiers and civilians dead and forced millions of people to flee their homes. Ukrainian national security secretary Rustem Umerov led Kyiv's side. Umerov said the talks were “intensive and substantive”, in a brief statement to reporters after. He said the next step was to try to reach a level of consensus to

“submit the developed decisions for consideration by the presidents”. Trump put pressure on Ukraine on Monday to make a deal, saying they “better come to the table, fast”. But Zelensky told Axios on Tuesday it was “not fair” that Ukraine -- and not Russia -- was facing more pressure, adding that lasting peace would not be achieved if “victory” was just handed to Moscow. “I hope it is just his tactics and not the decision,” Zelensky said. Ukraine says handing Russia more territory will effectively “reward” Russia for invading it to attack again.

Japan reappoints Sanae Takaichi as Prime Minister following election

IITM Bureau

Japan's lower house formally reappointed Sanae Takaichi as Prime Minister on February 18, 10 days after her historic landslide election victory. Ms. Takaichi, 64, became Japan's first woman premier in October and won a two-thirds majority for her party in the snap lower house elections on February 8. She has pledged to bolster Japan's defences to protect its territory and waters, likely further straining relations with Beijing, and to boost the flagging economy. Ms. Takaichi suggested in November that Japan could intervene militarily if Beijing sought to take Taiwan by force. China, which regards



the democratic island as part of its territory and has not ruled out force to annex it, was furious. Beijing's top diplomat Wang Yi told the Munich Security Conference on Saturday (February 14) that forces in Japan were seeking to “revive militarism”. In a policy speech expected for Friday (February 20), Ms. Takaichi will pledge to update Japan's “Free and

Open Indo-Pacific” strategic framework, local media reported. “Compared with when FOIP was first proposed, the international situation and security environment surrounding Japan have become significantly more severe,” Chief Government Spokesman Minoru Kihara said on February 16. In practice, this will likely mean strengthening supply

chains and promoting free trade through the Trans-Pacific Partnership (CPTPP) that Britain joined in 2024. Ms. Takaichi's government also plans to pass legislation to establish a National Intelligence Agency and to begin concrete discussions towards an anti-espionage law, the reports said. Ms. Takaichi has promised too to tighten rules surrounding immigration, even though Asia's number two economy is struggling with labour shortages and a falling population. On February 20, Ms. Takaichi will repeat her campaign pledge to suspend consumption tax on food for two years in order to ease inflationary pressures.

Guterres slams international failure to manage safe migration

IITM Bureau

A 2018 agreement that aims to strengthen international cooperation on migration management must become reality, the UN Secretary-General said on February 27, in New York. António Guterres presented his latest biennial report on the Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration to Member States during an informal meeting of the General Assembly. It shows that in 2024, an estimated 304 million people were migrants, or 3.7 per cent of the world's population. Children accounted for between 12 to 14 per cent, or around 37 to 42 million. Mr. Guterres told ambassadors that the report



makes one truth unmistakably clear: “Migration is not a crisis. The crisis is the failure to manage it together.” The Global Compact underscores that no country can manage migration alone, especially as the international community confronts challenges such as climate change, demographic shifts or economic transformation. Although “human mobility” is profoundly shaping the world, “the global reaction has

too often been driven by fear, division, and rank opportunism,” the Secretary-General noted. “Across continents, migrants are being instrumentalised to score political points –with devastating human consequences,” he said. “They are being dehumanised in public discourse. And they are being denied the rights and dignity that belong to every member of the human family – despite the enormous contributions migrants make to

economies and societies.” This is happening at a time when safe and regular pathways for migration – labour schemes and family reunification, for example – are becoming even more restrictive, pushing people to resort to smugglers and undertake dangerous journeys. More than 48,000 migrants have died or gone missing in transit since the Compact's adoption, according to the report— issued a day after the UN migration agency IOM affirmed that sea crossings like the central Mediterranean remain among the deadliest routes. The UN urged countries to work together to ensure safer and more humane migration policies.

IITM Organizes Seminar on Sensationalism vs. Public Interest: Examining Ethical Challenges in Contemporary News Reporting

IITM Bureau

The School of Mass Communication at the Institute of Information Technology and Management (IITM) successfully organized a seminar on “Sensationalism vs. Public Interest: Examining Ethical Challenges in Contemporary News Reporting” on 27th February 2026. The seminar was conducted for the students of BA (Journalism & Mass Communication), 2nd Semester, with the objective of strengthening their understanding of ethical practices in contemporary journalism. The session witnessed enthusiastic participation from students and faculty members.

The seminar aimed to address the growing tension between sensational reporting and the media’s responsibility to uphold public interest, a subject that has gained increasing relevance in the age of 24/7 news cycles and digital media competition. The distinguished guest speaker for the session was Mr. Vikas Kumar, Senior Journalist and Producer at Lokmat Hindi, who has extensive experience in political and parliamentary reporting, covering legislative developments and public affairs. Drawing from his professional experience, he provided deep insights into the practical challenges faced by journalists in balancing viewer



engagement with ethical responsibility. During his address, Mr. Kumar discussed how sensationalism often emerges from commercial pressures, TRP competition, and the race for digital visibility. He emphasized that while audience attention is important for media survival, it must not come at the cost of credibility, accuracy, and fairness. He illustrated his points

with real-world examples from contemporary news coverage, highlighting instances where exaggerated headlines and dramatic framing overshadowed factual reporting. The speaker further elaborated on the concept of public interest journalism, explaining that responsible media reporting must prioritize verified facts, contextual clarity, and societal impact over

emotional provocation. He underlined that journalists act as watchdogs of democracy and must maintain professional integrity even under pressure from political, corporate, or institutional forces. The seminar also focused on ethical standards and professional responsibilities in journalism practice. Students were encouraged to critically examine news content and differentiate between information that genuinely serves public interest and content designed primarily to attract attention. The discussion explored key ethical principles such as accuracy, accountability, impartiality, and sensitivity in reporting.

Motivational Talk on “Build Your Best Self” Organized at IITM Janakpuri

Kartik Chandel

The Institute of Information Technology and Management (IITM), Janakpuri, organized an inspiring motivational session titled “Build Your Best Self-Shaping Tomorrow’s Success Today” on February 28 2026. The session aimed to guide students on the importance of discipline, leadership, and personal development in achieving long-term success. The keynote speaker for the session was Col. M. M. Nehru (Retd.), who shared his valuable experiences and insights with the students. Drawing from his distinguished career and life experiences, he emphasized the significance of dis-



cipline, commitment, and a positive mindset in shaping one’s personal and professional journey. His inspiring words encouraged students to develop self-confidence, resilience, and clarity of purpose while working towards their goals. During the session, Col. Nehru highlighted the role of strong leadership qualities and self-belief in overcoming challenges and achieving excellence. He also motivated stu-

dents to focus on continuous learning and self-improvement in order to prepare themselves for the opportunities and responsibilities of the future. The session allowed students to reflect on their aspirations and understand the practical steps required to build a successful career. The session concluded with a note of gratitude to Col. M. M. Nehru (Retd.) for his enlightening address.

Department of Commerce, IITM Hosts Guest Lecture on Developing Core Life Skills through the Bhagavad Gita

Ananya Manchanda

Department of Commerce, organized an insightful guest lecture on 27th February 2026 on “Developing Core Life Skills through Bhagavad Gita.” The session was thoughtfully designed to help students understand how ancient Indian wisdom can play a significant role in shaping strong moral values and essential life skills required in today’s fast-paced, competitive, and ever-evolving world. The lecture sought to bridge the gap between traditional philosophical knowledge and the practical challenges faced by modern youth in their academic, professional, and personal lives. The lecture was deliv-



ered by Dr. Priyanka Murria, an esteemed academician and distinguished resource person, who elaborated on the timeless relevance of the Bhagavad Gita. She emphasized that even after nearly 5,000 years, the teachings of the Gita continue to inspire individuals across generations, cultures, and professions. According to her, the Bhagavad Gita is not merely a sacred spiritual text

but also a practical guidebook that offers profound insights into stress management, ethical decision-making, leadership development, and the cultivation of inner strength and self-confidence. She explained how its teachings provide clarity in moments of confusion and stability during times of uncertainty. During her address, Dr. Murria highlighted essential values such as self-discipline,

clarity of thought, emotional balance, resilience, commitment to duty, and integrity. She explained that these principles enable individuals to remain calm, focused, and composed even in challenging situations. She further stressed the importance of maintaining inner harmony and spiritual balance while fulfilling personal and professional responsibilities. Through relatable real-life examples and simple interpretations of key concepts, she demonstrated how the teachings of the Gita can enhance leadership qualities, strengthen decision-making abilities, and promote overall mental and emotional well-being.

IITM Organizes UMUNG 4.0: Annual Model United Nations Conference

IITM Bureau

The Institute of Information Technology & Management (IITM), successfully organized UMUNG 4.0, the fourth edition of its Annual Model United Nations Conference, under the aegis of the InternWare Internship Cell, on 23–24 February 2026. The two-day conference witnessed enthusiastic participation from delegates representing various cities, creating a vibrant and intellectually stimulating platform for dialogue, debate, and diplomatic engagement. Students from diverse academic disciplines came together to deliberate on pressing global challenges, demonstrating strong research aptitude, articulate public



speaking skills, and refined negotiation techniques. UMUNG 4.0 featured multiple dynamic committees that engaged delegates in structured debates and in-depth discussions on significant international agendas. Participants actively represented their assigned countries, defended national policies, and proposed strategic solutions while adhering to parliamentary procedures. The

committees witnessed rigorous drafting of resolutions, moderated caucuses, and constructive negotiations, truly reflecting the spirit and functioning of the United Nations. The conference provided valuable practical exposure to global policymaking processes and enhanced participants’ analytical thinking, leadership capabilities, and problem-solving skills. Beyond the formal

committee sessions, UMUNG 4.0 also offered ample opportunities for networking, collaboration, and peer learning. Delegates interacted with like-minded individuals, exchanged perspectives on global affairs, and developed meaningful professional connections. The engaging informal sessions, well-structured event management, and vibrant atmosphere contributed to an enriching and memorable experience. Through initiatives like UMUNG 4.0, IITM continues to strengthen its commitment to experiential learning and holistic development, empowering students to evolve into effective leaders of tomorrow.

Educational Visit to Bharat Bodhan AI Conclave 2026 Inspires Future Tech Leaders

IITM Bureau

The Department of Computer Science, IITM Janakpuri, organized an educational visit for BCA and MCA students to the Bharat Bodhan AI Conclave 2026 held at Bharat Mandapam. The visit was thoughtfully conducted in two phases to ensure effective participation and engagement. The first group of 50 students attended the conclave on 12 February 2026, followed by another group of 50 students on 13 February 2026. The initiative was designed to provide students with valuable practical

exposure to the rapidly evolving and highly dynamic field of Artificial Intelligence. The primary objective of the visit was to bridge the gap between theoretical classroom learning and real-world technological applications. Through interactive exhibitions, live demonstrations, panel discussions, and expert-led sessions, students gained firsthand insight into how AI-driven technologies are transforming various industries, including healthcare, finance, education, cybersecurity, and e-commerce. The conclave served

as a vibrant platform where academic knowledge seamlessly connected with industry innovation and research advancements. During the visit, students explored emerging AI tools, intelligent systems, automation solutions, and data-driven technologies that are shaping the future of business and society. They were introduced to contemporary industry practices, innovation trends, and practical problem-solving strategies adopted by leading technology organizations and startups. The experience



enabled students to understand how concepts of Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Data Science, and analytics are applied to address complex real-world challenges efficiently and effectively. The visit also aimed to motivate students to pursue research, innovation, and higher

studies in Computer Science and Artificial Intelligence. By observing cutting-edge technological developments and interacting directly with industry experts and innovators, students developed enhanced confidence, professional awareness, and enthusiasm for continuous learning.

“Reel to Retail” Marketing Challenge Held at COMMPARV 3.0 2K26

Kartik Chandel

The Department of Commerce at the Institute of Information Technology and Management (IITM) successfully organized an exciting marketing competition titled “Reel to Retail - The Ultimate Reel Marketing Challenge” during COMMPARV 3.0 2K26 organized on February 18 2026. The event brought together creative and aspiring marketers who showcased their ability to transform digital storytelling into effective marketing strategies.

The competition focused on the growing influence of short-form digital content in modern marketing. Participants were challenged to create engaging Instagram-style reels while also presenting strong marketing strategies behind their content. Moving beyond simple content creation, the competition encouraged students to build compelling brand narratives and demonstrate how creative storytelling can convert online engagement into tangible business value. Students enthusiastically

participated in the event, presenting innovative ideas and strategic approaches to digital marketing. The competition highlighted the importance of creativity, strategic planning, and audience engagement in today’s rapidly evolving digital marketplace. The event was evaluated by a distinguished panel of judges comprising Mr. Aman Kapoor, Senior Professor at IIDE, and Dr. Anurag Tiruwa, Assistant Professor at IITM. The event concluded on a high note, celebrating creativity.

Middle East Conflict Raises Concerns for India's Economic Stability

IITM Bureau

Rising tensions in the Middle East, particularly between Israel and Iran, have raised concerns about their possible economic impact on India. As geopolitical uncertainties intensify in the region, economists and policymakers warn that any further escalation could affect India's macroeconomic stability through higher oil prices, disrupted trade routes, and volatility in global financial markets. Since the Covid-19 pandemic subsided, the global economy has been grappling with a series of geopolitical crises. The ongoing Russia-Ukraine conflict and the Israel-Hamas war have already strained global supply

chains and commodity markets. The latest tensions between Israel and Iran have added another layer of uncertainty, with the potential to influence global energy prices and investor confidence. India, the world's third-largest consumer of crude oil, relies heavily on imports for more than 85 percent of its energy needs. Any disruption in oil supplies from the Middle East could push global crude prices significantly higher, placing additional pressure on India's economy. Higher oil prices tend to increase inflation by raising transportation and logistics costs, which eventually affects the prices of goods and services across the country.

Several industries are particularly vulnerable to rising energy costs. Key sectors such as automobiles, aviation, transportation, paints, tyres, cement, and chemicals depend heavily on fuel and petroleum-based inputs. A sustained increase in oil prices could raise production costs for these industries, potentially reducing profit margins and slowing economic growth. Analysts also warn that prolonged high energy prices could dampen consumer spending, further affecting economic activity. Another concern relates to the security of major maritime trade routes. Although India does not directly import crude oil from Iran due to U.S. sanc-

tions, experts caution that Iran could potentially disrupt shipping through the Strait of Hormuz. This narrow waterway is one of the most important oil transit routes in the world, through which a large share of global crude supply passes. Any disruption in this corridor could severely affect international energy markets and trigger a surge in oil prices. Rising crude prices could also widen India's current account deficit, as the country would have to spend more on importing energy. A higher import bill could weaken the Indian currency and influence foreign investment flows. While fluctuations in crude oil prices usually have a stronger impact on the

Wholesale Price Index than on the Consumer Price Index, sustained price increases can eventually influence both indicators. At the same time, India's economic engagement with the Middle East has been expanding in recent years. Initiatives such as the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor aim to strengthen trade connectivity between India, the Gulf region, and Europe. Gulf countries are also diversifying their economies beyond oil, creating new opportunities for trade and investment. The India-UAE Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has significantly boosted non-oil trade between the two countries.

Fresh Counselling Brings Relief to 50 MBBS Aspirants in J&K

IITM Bureau

India's stock market experienced a sharp decline in February 2026 as heavy selling in information technology (IT) stocks dragged down major market indices. The Nifty IT index recorded its steepest monthly fall since the 2008 global financial crisis, reflecting growing concerns among investors about the future growth prospects of the technology sector. During the month, the Nifty IT index fell by around 21 percent, wiping out nearly \$68 billion in market value from major technology companies. The sharp correction affected leading IT firms such as Infosys, Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), Wipro,

and HCL Technologies, whose shares witnessed significant declines amid heavy selling pressure. Analysts say one of the key reasons behind the sell-off is the rising uncertainty surrounding artificial intelligence (AI) and its potential impact on the traditional IT services model. Rapid developments in AI technologies have raised concerns that automation could reduce demand for certain outsourcing and software services that have long been a major revenue source for Indian IT companies. Global economic conditions also contributed to the downturn. Weak demand from major overseas markets such as the United States

and Europe, along with cautious spending by global technology companies, has affected investor sentiment toward the sector. Since Indian IT firms generate a large share of their revenue from international clients, any slowdown in global technology spending tends to directly impact their growth outlook. The decline in IT stocks also weighed on the broader stock market, causing volatility in benchmark indices such as the BSE Sensex and NSE Nifty 50. Market experts believe that while valuations of several IT companies have become more attractive after the correction, investors remain cautious.

Elon Musk says space will be the cheapest place for AI data centres in three years

IITM Bureau

Tech entrepreneur Elon Musk has said that artificial intelligence (AI) could become smarter than the entire human population combined within the next five years, a development he believes will dramatically transform the way people work, travel, and interact with technology. Speaking about the rapid progress of AI on February 6, 2026, Musk linked its growth to advancements in humanoid robotics. According to him, these technologies could significantly expand global economic productivity. Musk noted that humanoid robots developed by Tesla are already being tested in industrial environments. The

company's humanoid robot, Optimus, is currently performing simple tasks in factories, with more sophisticated capabilities expected soon. Musk said Tesla aims to begin selling humanoid robots to the general public as early as next year if development progresses smoothly. However, he emphasized that safety would remain a top priority before any large-scale rollout. According to him, the widespread adoption of robots will require proper regulation and supervision to ensure responsible use. While discussing the rapid growth of AI technology, Musk warned that energy supply could become a major challenge for future expansion. He argued



that electricity generation is not increasing quickly enough to support the growing infrastructure needed for advanced AI systems. “AI chips are being produced faster than we can power them,” Musk said, stressing that renewable energy particularly solar power may provide the most practical solution. He also highlighted China’s rapid expansion of solar energy capacity, suggesting that other countries need to accelerate their clean energy efforts to support technologi-

cal growth. Musk also spoke about the space exploration work being carried out by SpaceX. He said the company is working toward full rocket reusability with its Starship spacecraft, which could reduce the cost of reaching space by up to 100 times if successful. When asked what continues to drive his ambitions, Musk said curiosity and the desire to understand reality motivate him. Asked whether he would travel to Mars, Musk replied humorously: “Yes, but just not on impact.”

IITM Bureau

India's economy recorded strong growth in the third quarter of the financial year 2025–26, with Gross Domestic Product (GDP) expanding by 7.8% during the October–December period, according to official data released by the government in February 2026. The figures were published by the National Statistics Office (NSO) under the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation as part of the new GDP series with 2022–23 as the base year. According to the estimates, real GDP at constant prices reached about ₹84.54 lakh crore in the third quarter, compared with ₹78.41 lakh crore during the same period in the previous



year. Nominal GDP, which reflects current prices, was estimated at ₹90.91 lakh crore, indicating an annual growth rate of about 8.9%. These figures highlight the continued expansion of the Indian economy despite global economic uncertainties. Although the growth rate was slightly lower than the 8.4% recorded in the previous quarter, India continues to remain one of the fastest-growing major economies in the world. Strong domestic consumption played a key role in

sustaining growth, with private consumption expenditure rising by about 8.7% year-on-year during the quarter. Several sectors contributed to this economic expansion. Manufacturing and services showed solid performance, while construction and financial services also supported overall growth. The services sector remains the largest contributor to the economy, accounting for more than half of India's GDP and continuing to expand with the growth of dig-

ital services, finance, and trade. Despite the strong performance, some sectors experienced slower growth. Agricultural output growth moderated during the quarter, and government spending and investment growth also eased slightly compared with earlier months. However, economists believe that the overall economic momentum remains strong due to robust domestic demand and continued infrastructure investment. For the full financial year 2025–26, India's GDP growth is estimated at around 7.6%, which is higher than the previous year's 7.1%. Analysts believe that sustained consumption will continue to support India's economic growth in the coming years.

India Crosses 50 GW Power Capacity Addition in April-January, Boosting Energy Security

Dr. Rajnesh Kumar Pandey

India has achieved a major milestone in its energy sector by adding more than 50 gigawatts (GW) of power generation capacity during the April-January period, reflecting the rapid expansion of the country's power infrastructure, as reported on February 16, 2026. The achievement highlights strong investment momentum, accelerated project implementation, and a growing shift toward renewable energy sources. The expansion comes at a time when electricity demand in the

country is steadily increasing due to economic growth, urbanization, and the rising use of energy-intensive technologies. The addition of such a large capacity within a short period strengthens India's ability to meet future demand and maintain reliable power supply across sectors. Officials say the milestone demonstrates the combined efforts of both public and private sector investments in the power industry. New projects across thermal, hydro, solar, and wind power segments have contributed to the overall

increase in generation capacity. This diversified energy mix helps reduce dependence on a single energy source and enhances the resilience of the national power system. A significant share of the new capacity has come from renewable energy projects. Solar and wind power installations have grown rapidly in recent years due to declining technology costs, supportive government policies, and rising investor interest. The expansion of clean energy capacity is also an important step toward reducing carbon emissions and



advancing India's climate commitments. Energy experts believe that the addition of over 50 GW within ten months significantly strengthens the country's energy security. A larger generation base ensures better supply availability, helps manage peak demand, and reduces the risk of

power shortages across industrial, commercial, and residential sectors. The increased capacity is also expected to support economic development. Industries such as manufacturing, infrastructure, data centers, and electric mobility depend heavily on reliable electricity supply. Greater

generation capacity ensures that energy constraints do not hinder industrial expansion and investment. Alongside generation growth, improvements in transmission and distribution infrastructure are becoming equally important. Strengthening the national grid, building modern substations, and improving inter-regional connectivity will help ensure that newly generated power reaches consumers efficiently. Experts say the rapid pace of capacity addition reflects the impact of recent policy initiatives aimed

at strengthening the power sector. Renewable energy targets streamlined project approvals, and incentives for private participation have helped accelerate development. The milestone marks a significant step toward building a stronger, more sustainable energy system capable of supporting India's long-term economic growth. In the coming years, maintaining this momentum will be crucial for ensuring a reliable and sustainable power supply across the country. Continued investment in renewable

energy, modernization of the power grid, and improvements in energy storage and efficiency will further strengthen India's energy sector. As demand continues to rise, such developments will play a vital role in supporting economic growth, promoting environmental sustainability, and ensuring long-term energy security for the nation. Moreover, greater focus on energy efficiency, smart grids, and digital monitoring systems will help improve the overall performance of the power sector.

BAFTA Awards 2026: India's Boong scripts history, clinches first-ever win in Best Children's and Family Film category

Anjali Yadav

India shone bright at the prestigious BAFTA Awards this year. Boong, the Manipuri-language debut feature, has won in the Best Children and Family Film category. It was the sole Indian nominee at the BAFTAs this year. The announcement was made by the official BAFTA page. Directed by Lakshmipriya Devi and produced by Farhan Akhtar along with Vikesh Bhutani, Alan McAlex, Ritesh Sidhwani and Shujaat Saudagar, the film stars Gugun Kipgen and Bala Hijam. Farhan Akhtar was present at the ceremony to collect the award. Boong premiered at the 2024 Toronto In-

ternational Film Festival in the Discovery section and has since been screened at several global festivals, including the Warsaw International Film Festival 2024, MAMI Mumbai Film Festival 2024, the 55th International Film Festival of India, and the Indian Film Festival of Melbourne 2025.

The film follows the story of a young boy named Boong, from the valley of Manipur, who plans to surprise his mother with a gift. In his innocence, he believes that bringing his father back home would be the most special gift. His search for his father leads to an unexpected gift – a new beginning. Meanwhile, the 79th British



Academy Film Awards were held at London's Royal Festival Hall. Accepting the honour at the British Academy of Film and Television Arts ceremony, Lakshmipriya Devi appeared visibly overwhelmed. "To walk up till here felt like the last few steps to reach a summit of a mountain we never knew we were climbing in the first place," she said, capturing the

unlikely journey of Boong from Manipur to the global stage. She then spoke about the unrest back home, saying, "We pray for peace to return to Manipur. We pray that all the internally displaced children, including the child actors in the film, regain their joy, their innocence, and their dream once again." Closing her speech with a plea for com-

passion, she added, "We pray that no conflict is ever formidable enough to destroy the one super power that all of us have as human beings, that is forgiveness. So thank you, BAFTA, for giving us not only an award, but this stage to express our hope."

Actor and producer Alia Bhatt presented an award at the ceremony. Speaking on the red carpet, Alia said, "Being in front of the camera to me is a blessing. I feel so grateful. But I have to say that my true source of inspiration and magic right now is my daughter. Looking at her, she just blooms. She's three now and dancing to my songs, sometimes, I'm, like, 'Ok, that is life'."

SS Rajamouli unveils India's 'most advanced' Motion Capture Lab at Annapurna Studios

Bhavya Aneja

Annapurna Studios has introduced the country's most advanced Motion Capture facility. Christened as A&M MoCap Lab, this facility is the result of a partnership between renowned actor Akkineni Nagarjuna's Annapurna Studios and producer Shobu Yarlagadda's Mihira Visual Labs. The facility is powered by Hollywood's leading motion capture technology partner Animatrik Film Design. SS Rajamouli introduced the A&M Motion Capture facility and explained how key sequences of his upcoming film Varanasi, starring Mahesh Babu and Priyanka Chopra Jonas, were shot using the tech-



nology. He also shared the first ever glimpse of the Motion Capture facility, highlighting how this technology is shaping the scale and ambition of Indian storytelling. Rajamouli, who had earlier launched India's first Dolby cinema processing facility at Annapurna Studios, spoke about how the Motion Capture facility represents a defining mo-

ment for filmmakers in the country. "India has always had some of the world's best technicians contributing to major global productions, but what we lacked was an advanced facility right here at home. When I look back at some of my previous films like Bahubali, Eega etc., I reminisce how I could have made them even better if I had access

to motion capture technology back then in India," Rajamouli said. "With the introduction of A&M's Motion Capture technology, that gap has finally been bridged. This will change how Indian filmmakers envision and execute their stories as we will no longer need to outsource. I have visited several Motion Capture facilities across the world, but what A&M offers is the perfect blend of precision and performance. We utilised this facility in the making of crucial sequences in Varanasi, and the results were simply fantastic," the filmmaker added. Nagarjuna Akkineni defined the facility as a major milestone in India's cinematic journey.

Amid Rs. 9 Crore Cheque Bounce Controversy, Rajpal Yadav Claims ₹1,200 Crore Worth Projects and Breaks Silence in Fiery Press Conference

Bhavya Aneja

Bollywood's famed actor Rajpal Yadav has been in the headlines recently over a Rs. 9 crore cheque bounce case. To address the matter, the actor, along with his lawyer Bhaskar Upadhyay, held a press conference on Saturday. During the interaction with the media, he revealed that he currently has 1,200 crore worth of work. He also sought to debunk claims made by Madhav Gopal Agrawal, stating that the case is not linked to the 2013 cheque. Rajpal said, "If Rajpal doesn't even have a single rupee in his pocket, believe me, for the next 10 years, there are 36 guest houses in this country for us, for love not for position."



He added, "If we go to any district, there are sometimes 15 vehicles, sometimes 10 vehicles, in which I never have to put diesel. So, at the very least, Rajpal Yadav owns 7,000 vehicles in this country." He also claimed that wherever he goes, a DM and commissioner are present in the district to assist him. Explaining more about his wealth, Rajpal said he currently has 1,200 crore worth of work with four agreements in hand. He noted that

to go back to those at some point?", to which Rothman responded, "Yes." Matthew also asked if the new iteration of the universe would be a "fresh reboot" with "new people." Tom Rothman confirmed both ideas, acknowledging that the next wave of Sony-Marvel movies will feature fresh faces. Later in the conversation, Rothman reflected on the broader challenges facing the superhero genre, particularly in light of declining box office returns. When Belloni asked about his perspective on the Marvel Cinematic Universe under The Walt Disney Company, Rothman discussed the evolving market-

place and audience fatigue around superhero films. Sony has controlled the theatrical rights to Spider-Man since 1999. The studio first struck gold with Sam Raimi's early 2000s trilogy starring Tobey Maguire. In the early 2010s, Sony attempted a reboot with Andrew Garfield in the lead, though those films received a more muted response.

A major turning point came in 2017 when Sony partnered with Marvel Studios to introduce Spider-Man into the MCU with Spider-Man: Homecoming, starring Tom Holland. The collaboration proved commercially successful and reinvigorated the character on the big screen.

yours. The money that came from each person will be returned to their account along with the same amount of gratitude and appreciation." The actor further expressed his gratitude towards his fans, calling their support a debt he can never repay. He revealed that he has a plan extending till 2035, adding, "Rajpal Yadav kabhi doob hua nahi tha, uljha hua tha." Towards the end of his statement he added, 'Raja tha, Raja hoon, aur Raja hi rahunga. Raja chahe jail mein ho ya jungle mein, Raja Raja hota hai.'

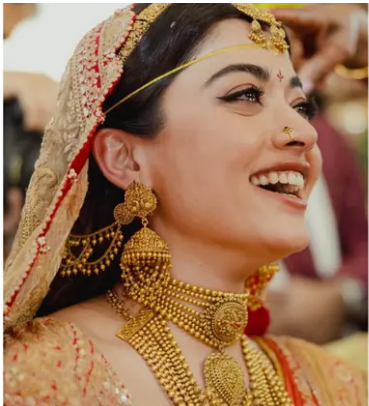
In addition, Rajpal officially launched his YouTube channel to connect directly with his fans.

Vijay Deverakonda and Rashmika Mandanna Tie the Knot in a Grand Yet Intimate Traditional Wedding Ceremony

Anjali Yadav

In a moment that delighted millions of fans across the country, celebrated actors Vijay Deverakonda and Rashmika Mandanna have officially tied the knot, marking one of the most anticipated celebrity weddings of the year. The couple, admired for both their on-screen chemistry and off-screen bond, solemnised their relationship in a private yet culturally rich ceremony rooted in traditional South Indian customs. The wedding took place in an inti-

mate setting, attended by close family members and a carefully curated guest list from the film fraternity. Despite their immense popularity, the couple chose to keep the ceremony personal and meaningful rather than extravagant. Dressed in traditional attire, Vijay looked elegant in a classic silk ensemble, while Rashmika radiated grace in a red saree, symbolising cultural heritage and timeless beauty. For years, the duo had been the subject of widespread speculation regarding their



relationship. Their frequent public appearances together and strong camaraderie had led fans to affectionately nickname them as a pair. However, the wedding has now confirmed what admirers had long believed —



a deep and enduring connection between the two stars. The pre-wedding celebrations reflected a perfect blend of joy, tradition, and modernity. Among the highlights was a unique cricket match organ-

ised for friends and family, adding a fun and personal touch to the festivities. The sangeet ceremony was equally memorable, filled with emotional moments, music, and heartfelt participation from loved ones. What

truly set the wedding apart was the couple's thoughtful gesture towards their fans. Soon after the ceremony, specially curated sweet boxes were distributed among media personnel and well-wishers. These boxes contained traditional Indian sweets along with a personalised note and a photograph of the couple from their wedding day. This act symbolised gratitude and acknowledged the unwavering support they have received throughout their careers. Continuing their commitment to tradi-

tion, the newlyweds also participated in post-wedding rituals and visited temples to seek blessings for their new journey. Such gestures highlighted their rootedness in cultural values despite their modern and high-profile lifestyles. A grand reception is expected to follow in Hyderabad, where industry colleagues and extended acquaintances will gather to celebrate the union. However, reports suggest that the event will maintain exclusivity, with a limited guest list to ensure privacy and security.

The wedding of Vijay Deverakonda and Rashmika Mandanna is more than just a celebrity event; it represents a union that resonates deeply with fans across generations. By balancing simplicity with celebration and tradition with modernity, the couple has set an example of how personal milestones can be both meaningful and widely cherished. As they embark on this new chapter together, their journey continues to inspire admiration, warmth, and heartfelt wishes from across the nation.

IITM Bureau

India concluded a remarkable campaign at the Asian Shooting Championships 2026 in New Delhi with an impressive performance, securing seven medals on the final day. With this, India's tally in senior rifle and pistol events reached 33 medals, including 13 gold, 11 silver and nine bronze. Overall, the host nation dominated the championship by finishing at the top of the medal standings with a total of 94 medals 51 gold, 23 silver and 20 bronze

Jammu and Kashmir's Ranji Trophy triumph sparks India dreams in the Valley

IITM Bureau

The historic victory of the Jammu and Kashmir cricket team in the Ranji Trophy has ignited fresh hopes and ambitions among young cricketers across the Kashmir Valley. After decades of participation in India's premier domestic cricket tournament, Jammu and Kashmir finally lifted their maiden Ranji Trophy title by defeating Karnataka cricket team in the 2025–26 final, marking a historic milestone for the region's sporting landscape.

Delhi Women Beat Railways by 7 Wickets to Win Senior Women's One-Day Trophy 2025-26 Final

IITM Bureau

The 2025-26 Senior Women's One Day Trophy Elite final at the IS Bindra Cricket Stadium in Mohali on 28th February 2026 will be remembered as the day Delhi Women finally toppled the giants of the domestic circuit. Entering the match against a Railways side that has historically owned this competition, Delhi produced a clinical performance to secure a dominant 7-wicket victory. By bowling out the defending champions for a low total and chasing it down with over 21 overs to spare, Delhi proved they were the undisputed best team of the tournament. The foundation of this historic win was laid by a relentless Delhi bowling attack that never allowed the Railways batters to find their rhythm. Railways, usually known for their batting depth, struggled from the



highlighting the country's growing strength in shooting sports. The final day's action was headlined by veteran shooter Amanpreet Singh, who clinched gold in the men's 25m centre fire pistol event. The former world champion delivered a superb performance, scoring 589-24x across the precision and rapid rounds. In an outstanding display of dominance, Indian shooters completed a clean sweep of the podium in the event, with Gurpreet Singh winning silver with 584-20x and Ankur Goel securing bronze with



The triumph has not only brought pride to the Union Territory but has also transformed the aspirations of young cricket enthusiasts. For years, many youngsters in the Valley followed Indian cricket mainly as passionate fans. However, this victory has changed the narrative, inspiring them to believe that they too can represent India one day. Cricket academies in cities such as Srinagar and Sopore have reportedly witnessed a surge in young players eager to pursue the sport seriously after witnessing their

570-11x. The trio also combined to win the team gold medal with a total score of 1743-55x, finishing comfortably ahead of Vietnam. India also performed strongly in the women's 50m rifle prone event. Asian Games champion Sift Kaur Samra claimed the silver medal with a score of 623.2, narrowly missing the gold, which went to Kazakhstan's Yelizaveta Bezrukova with 623.4. Veteran Indian shooter Tejaswini Sawant added another medal to the tally by winning bronze with

local heroes succeed on the national stage. Jammu and Kashmir's remarkable Ranji Trophy campaign showcased resilience and determination. The team dominated several strong opponents during the tournament and eventually secured the title thanks to a commanding first-innings lead in the final. Their consistent performances throughout the season helped them script history by becoming the champions for the first time in the tournament's long history.

14 overs, scoring at a brisk rate that left the Railways' bowlers with no room for error. Priya Punia was the star of the chase, playing a composed and stylish innings of 76 runs and was also supported by Pragya Rawat who on the other end scored a brilliant 46 off 56 deliveries that anchored the top order and ensured Delhi stayed well ahead of the required rate from the very first ball. Despite the low total, Railways' veteran leg-spinner Poonam Yadav showed her class by picking up 2 wickets for 29 runs, but it wasn't enough to trigger a collapse. Delhi remained calm and reached the target of 134/3 in just 28.3 overs. Scoring at 4.7 runs per over, they cruised to the finish line to spark massive celebrations, officially ending the match with 129 balls remaining and cementing their place as the new champions of the Elite division.

621.0. India also secured gold in the women's 50m rifle prone team event, with Samra, Sawant and Manini Kaushik combining for a total of 1862.9. Earlier in the championship, two-time Olympian Aishwary Pratap Singh Tomar set a new world record score of 362.0 to win the men's 50m rifle three positions title, leading another podium sweep for India. Other standout performances included gold medals by Esha Singh in the women's 10m air pistol.

Preparations Intensify for Spectacular Opening Ceremony of Milano Cortina 2026 Winter Olympics

Kartik Chandel

Preparations are gaining momentum for the grand opening ceremony of the 2026 Winter Olympics (6 February – 22 February 2026), as organizers of the Milano Cortina Games work to deliver a spectacular start to one of the world's biggest sporting events. The ceremony will take place at the iconic San Siro Stadium in Milan on February 6 2026, where thousands of performers, technicians and volunteers are currently engaged in rehears-

Carlos Alcaraz beats Novak Djokovic in Australian Open final to complete career grand slam

IITM Bureau

Carlos Alcaraz was a phantom for the first 45 minutes of his maiden Australian Open final. While the Spaniard was painfully tentative on one of the most significant occasions of his career, he was suffocated by the eternal brilliance of Novak Djokovic, who burst into this historic match playing some of his best tennis in recent years. A younger version of Alcaraz may have compounded his slow start by overhitting, as was the case during parts of their fateful Olympic battle in Paris 18 months ago, but here he calmly worked his way into the match and then took control. In the process, he pulled off one of the great sporting achievements in recent years, recovering from a set down to defeat Djokovic 2-6, 6-2, 6-3, 7-5 and triumph at the Australian Open for the



als and final-stage arrangements. The opening ceremony will officially mark the beginning of the XXV Winter Olympic Games, which will be jointly hosted by Milan and Cortina d'Ampezzo. Organizers have planned an elaborate show that will combine modern technology, artistic performances,

first time in his career. This sport has produced many legendary young champions, from Björn Borg to Rafael Nadal, a witness from the first row of Rod Laver Arena. Alcaraz, however, continues to make his claim as the greatest young male tennis player that has ever lived. At only 22, Alcaraz is the youngest man to complete the career grand slam, a record that had been held by Don Budge since 1938, 87 years ago. Only eight other men have won all four grand slam titles. "Completing a career grand slam was something that was on my mind," said Alcaraz. "Every time that I come here to Australia, I made the pre-season just with my mind into this tournament to try to work as hard as I can and to be as well-prepared as I can, you know, to play this tournament and trying to get the trophy. In the previous years I



haven't gone in a good way, but I am really happy that I just push myself to be better and finally came this year." Thanks to Djokovic's astounding five-set defeat of Jannik Sinner on Friday, this was a historic occasion regardless of the outcome. By defeating Djokovic, he denied the Serb what would have been a crowning achievement of his peerless career as he tried to become the oldest grand slam champion in the open era and owner of an all-time record 25 grand slam singles titles. This was a mature, composed performance from a special athlete who has already established himself as

running between the wickets helped India comfortably cross the 250-run mark, giving the hosts a commanding total to defend. In reply, Zimbabwe faced an uphill task as the required run rate climbed rapidly. Although the middle order tried to build partnerships and stabilize the innings, wickets kept falling at crucial moments. India's bowlers maintained tight lines and bowling, preventing Zimbabwe from gaining any real momentum in the chase.

emony preparations. The programme will highlight Italy's rich history in art, music, fashion and design while celebrating the Olympic values of friendship, respect and excellence. The ceremony is also expected to feature performances by renowned Italian and international artists, adding glamour and global appeal to the event. The 2026 Winter Olympics are expected to bring together nearly 3,000 athletes from around the world, competing across multiple winter sports disciplines.

a legend of the game. Alcaraz started slowly as Djokovic performed at a staggering level, serving precisely and looking to take every last ball on the rise, striking his forehand so cleanly as he snatched the first set. Alcaraz slowly worked himself into the match but, rather than simply blasting through the 38-year-old, he intelligently forced Djokovic off the court with his width and angles, while soaking up the Serb's extreme aggression with his peerless defence. Djokovic struggled physically towards the end, but he put up a spectacular last stand in the fourth set.